

# Veranika Puhacheuskaya

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**Website:** [veranika-p.github.io/vp/](https://veranika-p.github.io/vp/)

**Office:** Assiniboia Hall 1-02D, Edmonton, Canada

## Research Interests

Foreign-accented speech, social identity, pragmatics, individual differences in language processing

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## Education

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| <b>University of Alberta</b>                      | Edmonton, Canada |
| Ph.D. in Linguistics                              | 2019 – 2025      |
| Supervisor: Juhani Järvikivi. <i>GPA: 4.0/4.0</i> |                  |

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| <b>University of Wrocław</b>                      | Wrocław, Poland |
| MA in Linguistics                                 | 2016 – 2018     |
| Supervisor: Joanna Błaszczak. <i>GPA: 5.0/5.0</i> |                 |

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## Publications

**Language comprehension under uncertainty: The pragmatic implications of non-native accents and the role of individual differences**

Puhacheuskaya, V. (2025)

*Ph.D. Thesis*

[ualberta.scholaris.ca](https://ualberta.scholaris.ca)

**Sorry, you make less sense to me: The effect of non-native speaker status on metaphor processing**

Puhacheuskaya, V. & Järvikivi, J. (2025)

*Acta Psychologica*

[doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.104853](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2025.104853)

**COVIDisgust: Language processing through the lens of partisanship**

Puhacheuskaya, V., Hubert Lyall, I., & Järvikivi, J. (2022)

*PLOS ONE*

[doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0271206](https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0271206)

***I was being sarcastic!:* The effect of foreign accent and political ideology on irony (mis)understanding**

Puhacheuskaya, V., & Järvikivi, J. (2022)

*Acta Psychologica*

[doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2021.103479](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.actpsy.2021.103479)

**The influence of aspect on the countability of Polish deverbal nominalizations: Evidence from an acceptability rating study**

Gulgowski, P., Błaszczak, J., Puhacheuskaya, V. (2021)

*Zeitschrift für Sprachwissenschaft*

[doi.org/10.1515/zfs-2020-2014](https://doi.org/10.1515/zfs-2020-2014)

**The Role of Syntactic and Semantic Constraints in Relative Clause Attachment Processing in Russian: An Eye-Tracking Study**

Puhacheuskaya, V. (2020)

*Generative Linguistics in Wrocław, no. 7.*

[ifa.uni.wroc.pl/linguistics/page=538](https://ifa.uni.wroc.pl/linguistics/page=538)

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**Conferences**

**AMLaP 2024 (full talk)**

September 4-7, 2024

*No general pragmatic lenience toward foreigners: The effects of metaphorical language and person-based factors on sensibility ratings*

Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author) & Järvikivi, J.

**AMLaP 2024 (poster)**

September 4-7, 2024

*The “incredibility effect” revisited: The modality of stimuli and listeners’ implicit prejudice against foreign accents modulate world knowledge integration*

Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author) & Järvikivi, J.

**ICPhS 2023 (poster/short talk)**

August 7-11, 2021

*Labels speak volumes: The role of intergroup membership in accent perception*

Calkins, K. (presenting author), Puhacheuskaya, V., Kim, J., and Järvikivi, J.

**ACOL 2021 (poster/short talk)**

November 6, 2021

*Labels speak volumes: The role of intergroup membership in accent perception*

Calkins, K. (presenting author), Kim, J., Puhacheuskaya, V., and Järvikivi, J.

**Psychonomic Society 2021 (poster/short talk)**

November 4-7, 2021

*COVIDisgust: Language Processing at the Intersection of COVID-19, Politics, and Individual Differences*

Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author), Hubert Lyall, I., & Järvikivi, J.

**AMLaP 2021 (full talk)** September 2-4, 2021  
*The effect of foreign accent and political ideology on irony (mis)understanding*  
Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author) & Järvikivi, J.  
[Abstract](#)  
[Video](#)

**CogSci 2021 (poster/short talk)** July 26-29, 2021  
*Oh, the Irony!: Interpersonal Variation in the Processing of Foreign-Accented and Native Irony*  
Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author) & Järvikivi, J.

**CogSci 2021 (poster/short talk)** July 26-29, 2021  
*CoViDisgust: Language Comprehension at the Intersection of a Global Pandemic and Individual Disgust Sensitivity*  
Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author), Hubert Lyall, I., & Järvikivi, J.

**34th Annual CUNY Conference (poster/short talk)** March 4-6, 2021  
*Individual Differences in the Perception of Native and Foreign-Accented Irony*  
Puhacheuskaya, V. (presenting author) & Järvikivi, J.  
[Abstract](#)  
[Video](#)

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**Scholarships  
& Awards**

**Mary Louise Imrie Graduate Student Award** 2024  
Value: \$2,000

**Alberta Graduate Excellence Scholarship** 2022-2023  
Value: \$12,000

**University of Alberta Doctoral Recruitment Scholarship** 2019-2020  
Value: \$5,000

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**Guest Lectures  
& Workshops**

**PsychoPy 101:** June 12-13, 2023  
**A crash course on building customized experiments**  
Workshop  
STEP2023 – CCP Spring Training in Experimental Psycholinguistics  
University of Alberta

**Relative Clause Attachment in Russian:** April 2022  
**An Eye-Tracking Study**

Guest Lecture  
Ling 204 (Undergraduate Course)  
University of Alberta

**Visual World Paradigm & EyeLink 1000 Plus** Winter 2018  
Workshop  
Methods in Psycholinguistics (Graduate Course)  
University of Wrocław

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**Teaching  
Positions**

**Primary instructor (University of Alberta)** Winter 2024  
LING 101 - Introduction to Linguistic Analysis  
Creating lectures, creating and grading exams

**Teaching Assistant (University of Alberta)** Fall 2022  
LING 101 - Introduction to Linguistic Analysis  
Grading exams, attendance at lectures, office hours for students

**Teaching Assistant (University of Alberta)** Winter 2022  
LING 204 - Syntax of the World's Languages  
Grading exams, attendance at lectures, office hours for students

**Teaching Assistant (University of Alberta)** Fall 2021  
LING 204 - Syntax of the World's Languages  
Grading exams, attendance at lectures, office hours for students

**Teaching Assistant (University of Alberta)** Winter 2020  
LING 101 - Introduction to Linguistic Analysis  
Grading exams, attendance at lectures, office hours for students

**Teaching Assistant (University of Alberta)** Fall 2019  
LING 101 - Introduction to Linguistic Analysis  
Grading exams, office hours for students

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**Research  
Positions**

**Research Supervisor (University of Alberta)** Fall 2022  
Supervising two research assistants for the EEG project (providing EEG training, assigning tasks in data analysis and stimuli recording)

**Research Assistant (University of Alberta)** Fall 2020  
Department's tech support

**Lab Assistant (University of Wrocław)** Fall 2018  
Running eye-tracking, SPRT, and EEG experiments for the faculty

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| <b>University Service</b> | <b>Colloquium Liaison</b><br>Department of Linguistics, University of Alberta<br>Assisting in organizing invited talks held by the department | Fall 2022 |
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| <b>Conference Chair</b><br>Alberta Conference on Linguistics (ACOL)<br>University of Alberta | November 6, 2021 |
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| <b>Assistant Editor</b><br><i>Questions and Answers in Linguistics (QAL)</i><br>Department of Linguistics, University of Wrocław<br>Assisting in editing publications and finding reviewers for the department's journal | Fall 2017 |
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| <b>Certifications</b> | <b>freeCodeCamp</b><br>Data Analysis with Python<br>Numpy, Pandas, Matplotlib, SciPy<br><u>Certificate</u> | July 2025 |
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| <b>Skills</b> | <b>Programming</b><br>Proficient in: Python, R<br>Familiar with: SQL, HTML, CSS, JavaScript, MATLAB<br><br><b>Languages</b><br>Belarusian (native), English (fluent), Polish (advanced), French (intermediate)<br><br><b>Software</b><br>EyeLink 1000+, PsychoPy, E-Prime, BrainAmp, BioSemi, jsPsych, Praat, Latex |
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